EMILEIGH HARRISON

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Education

University of Chicago — Chicago, IL
PhD in Public Policy (Fields: Labor Economics and Econometrics) — *2019 – 2024*
Dissertation Committee: Anjali Adukia (chair), Marianne Bertrand, Michael Dinerstein, Steven Durlauf

University of Wisconsin Oshkosh — Oshkosh, WI
Bachelor of Business Administration in Economics and Marketing — *2015 – 2018*
Minors in Math and Statistics

University of Wisconsin Manitowoc — Manitowoc, WI
Associate of Arts and Science — *2013 - 2015*

Employment

LBJ School of Public Affairs — University of Texas at Austin
Assistant Professor — *2025 – Present*

Harris School of Public Policy Inclusive Economy Lab — University of Chicago
Principal Investigator — *2025 – Present*
Postdoctoral Scholar — *2024 – 2025*

MiiE Research Lab — University of Chicago
Principal Investigator — *2024 – Present*
Junior Investigator — *2019 – 2024*

Teaching Experience

Instructor — University of Texas at Austin
Introduction to Education Policy — *Spring 2026, Fall 2026*
Economics of Education (Graduate Course) — *Spring 2026, Fall 2026*

Guest Lecturer — University of Texas at Austin
Foundations of Public Affairs — *Fall 2025*
Education, Inequality, and Economic Development (Graduate Course) — *Winter 2024*

Teaching Assistant — University of Chicago
Applied Econometrics (PhD Course) — *Winter 2020, Winter 2021, Winter 2022, Winter 2023*
Quantitative Methods in Public Policy (Head TA) — *Winter 2021, Winter 2022*
Education and Economic Development (Graduate Course) — *Winter 2022*
Advanced Microeconomics for Public Policy (PhD Course) — *Fall 2019*
Math Camp for Incoming Harris Graduate Students — *Summer 2019*

Publications

"What We Teach about Race and Gender: Representation in Images & Text of Children's Books"
(August 2023, Quarterly Journal of Economics)
with A. Adukia, A. Eble, H.B. Runesha, T. Szasz

"Tales and Tropes: Gender Roles from Word Embeddings in a Century of Children's Books"
(October 2022, Proceedings of the 28th International Conference on Computational Linguistics (COLING))
with A. Adukia, P. Chiril, C. Christ, A. Das, A. Eble, H.B. Runesha

"Measuring Representation of Race, Gender, and Age in Children's Books: Face Detection and Feature Classification in Illustrated Images"
(January 2022, Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision)
with T. Szasz, P. Lin, P. Liu, H.B. Runesha, and A. Adukia

Working Papers

"Separation of Church and State Curricula? Public Standards, Private Values, and Textbook Content"
(Revised and Resubmitted *The Review of Economic Studies*) *with A. Adukia*

"(How) Do We Teach Emotions" (Submitted) *with A. Adukia, M. Bonci, P. Dastres, J. Nicoll, and T. Szasz*

"Category Embeddings Measure Intersectional Portrayals" (Submitted) *with A. Adukia, A. Eble, and J. Nicoll*

"The Effect of Merit-Based Free Community College" (Working Paper) *with K. Hallberg*

"Unpacking the Long-Term Impact of Holistic Supports for Community College Students" (Working Paper) *with K. Hallberg*

"Supporting the Early Academic Momentum of Community College Students: Examining the Impact of Incorporating GPA into Course Placement"
(Working Paper) *with K. Hallberg, Adam Leader-Smith, Elijah Ruiz, Marvin Slaughter, Courtney Washington*

Selected Works in Progress

"Natural Disasters, Labor Markets, and Economic Mobility of Young Adults" *with M. Vinnakota*

"Community College Deserts and Labor Market Outcomes" *with R. Acton, K. Cortes, L. Miller, and C. Morales*

"Social Change in Schools" *with A. Adukia, R. Hornbeck, and J. Nicoll*

"Skin Color, Marriage Markets, and Women's Empowerment in Bangladesh" *with A. Adukia, N. Buchmann, E. Field, and R. Glennerster*

Service

Reviewer, ***AEFP Annual Conference****, Post-secondary Student Access, Choice, and Affordability Section* *2027*
Committee Member, ***Committee on AI Use in PhD Qualifying Papers****, LBJ School at UT Austin* *2026*
Reviewer, ***NSF CAREER Statistics and Methods*** *2026*
Ad Hoc Reviewer, ***NSF Education and Human Resources Core Research*** *(ECR:CORE) Program* *2025*
Inaugural Co-Chair, ***First Generation Education Scholars*** *AEFP Community Group* *2021 – 2023*
Co-Coordinator, The ***UChicago Committee on Education*** *Workshop* *2021 – 2022*

Journal Refereeing

Quarterly Journal of Economics
American Educational Research Journal
The Review of Economics and Statistics

The Economic Journal
Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics
American Economic Journal: Economic Policy
Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization
Information Processing and Management
Economics of Education Review

Presentations and Invited Talks

(Upcoming) UChicago Committee on Education Workshop	*2023, 2027*
(Upcoming) NBER Economics of Religion Meeting	*2026*
CESifo Area Conference on Economics of Education	*2026*
Universidad de los Andes Workshop on Economics of Education	*2026*
Stanford Education Data Science Conference	*2026*
Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)	*2021, 2023, 2025, 2026*
Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)	*2023, 2025*
Oregon State University Applied Economics Seminar Series	*2025*
STATA Texas Empirical Microeconomics Conference	*2025*
University of Texas at Austin Political Methodology Workshop	*2025*
Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)	*2021, 2023, 2025*
Atlanta Workshop on Public Policy and Child Well-being (PPCW)	*2025*
Becker Friedman AI in Social Science Conference	*2024*
CESifo / ifo Junior Workshop on the Economics of Education	*2024*
American Educational Research Association (AERA)	*2024*
Zurich Workshop in AI+Economics	*2023*
Hoover Institution Workshop on Using Text as Data in Policy Analysis	*2023*
Carnegie Melon Heinz College of Information Systems and Public Policy Faculty Seminar	*2023*
Research Computing Expo and Symposium Mind Bytes	*2019, 2023*
NBER Economics of Culture and Institutions Meetings	*2022*
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	*2022*
NBER Education Meetings	*2021*

Affiliations

CESifo Research Affiliate	*2026 –*

Awards

Emerging Education Policy Scholar	*2027*
Finalist for Women in AI Awards North America (AI for Good - ESG AI Leader of the Year)	*2023*
UChicago Research Computing Expo and Symposium MindBytes Data Visualization Award	*2023*

Grants/Fellowships

"Natural Disasters and Economic Mobility of Young Adults." Policy Research Institute (Co-PI) $11,500	*2026*
"City Colleges of Chicago Star Scholarship Evaluation" Arnold Ventures (Co-PI) $200,000	*2024*
National Academy of Education/Spencer Foundation Dissertation Fellow $27,500	*2023*
Becker Friedman Institute Political Economics Initiative Grant $2,000	*2023*
Becker Friedman Institute Development Economics Center Grant $40,000	*2022*
Becker Friedman Institute Initiative for the Study of Gender in the Economy $20,000	*2022*
Becker Friedman Institute Political Economics Initiative Grant $7,000	*2022*
Doctoral Fellow at the UChicago Center for Data and Computing $2,000	*2019*